

O Lord, How Shall I Meet Thee

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1. O Lord, how shall I meet thee, how wel - come thee a - right?
 2. Love caused thy in - car - na - tion, love brought thee down to me;
 3. Re - joice, then, thou sad - heart - ed, who sit in deep - est gloom,
 4. Sin's debt, that fear - ful bur - den, let not thy souls dis - tress;

Thy peo - ple long to greet thee, my hope, my heart's de - light!
 thy thirst for my sal - va - tion pro - cured my lib - er - ty.
 who mourn o'er joys de - part - ed and trem - ble at thy doom.
 thy guilt the Lord will par - don and cov - er by his grace.

O kin - dle, Lord Most Ho - ly, thy lamp with - in my breast
 O love be - yond all tell - ing, that led thee to em - brace,
 De - spair not, he is near thee, yea, stand - ing at the door,
 He comes, for men pro - cur - ing the peace of sin for - giv'n,

to do in spir - it low - ly all that may please thee best.
 in love all love ex - cel - ling, our lost and fall - en race!
 who best can help and cheer thee and bids thee weep no more!
 for all God's sons se - cur - ing their her - i - tage in heav'n.

WORDS: Paul Gerhardt, 1653; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1863; alt.
 MUSIC: Melchior Teschner, ca. 1615

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 Matthew 25:6